

Chemicals Handling:

A Guide for Brewing & Hospitality Staff

Why This Matters:

Chemicals are used every day across our brewery, kitchen, bar and cleaning operations. Most are safe when handled correctly, but incorrect use can cause serious burns, eye injuries, breathing problems, poisoning or dangerous chemical reactions.

Know what you're using, wear the right protection, and never take shortcuts.



COMMON HAZARDS:

- Caustic and acidic brewery cleaning chemicals
 - Sanitisers and disinfectants
 - Beer line cleaning chemicals
 - Degreasers, oven and grill cleaners
 - Dishwasher and glasswasher chemicals
 - Bleach and chlorine-based cleaners
 - Chemicals being stored or decanted incorrectly
 - Unlabelled spray bottles or containers
 - Mixing incompatible chemicals
 - Chemical splashes to the skin or eyes
 - Fumes or vapours in poorly ventilated areas
 - Spills creating both chemical and slip hazards
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SIMPLE PREVENTION TIPS:



Personal Protective Equipment

- Always wear the PPE required for the chemical you are using.
- This may include gloves, safety glasses, goggles, face shields, aprons or enclosed footwear.
- Brewery staff handling concentrated caustic or acid must take particular care to protect their **eyes, face and skin**.
- Check gloves and other PPE for damage before use.
- PPE is the last line of defence — careful handling is still essential.



Know What You're Using

- Read the chemical label before use.
- Follow the manufacturer's instructions and workplace procedures.
- Safety Data Sheets (SDS) must be available for workplace chemicals.
- If you don't know what a chemical is or how to use it safely — **stop and ask**.
- Never use an unlabelled chemical.

Decanting & Labelling

- Never put chemicals into drink bottles, food containers, beer bottles or other containers that could be mistaken for food or drink.
- Any secondary container or spray bottle must be clearly labelled.
- Replace damaged or unreadable labels.
- Keep lids and caps fitted when chemicals are not being used.

Mixing & Diluting Chemicals

- **Never mix chemicals unless the procedure specifically requires it.**
- In particular, never mix bleach/chlorine products with acids or other cleaning chemicals — dangerous gases can be produced.
- Measure chemicals accurately rather than guessing.
- Follow the manufacturer's instructions for dilution.
- When preparing chemical solutions, add concentrates slowly and carefully as directed by the SDS or operating procedure.
- Avoid splashing when pouring or transferring chemicals.



BREWERY CHEMICAL SAFETY:

Brewing staff regularly work with stronger and more concentrated chemicals than other areas of the business.

Common Brewery Chemicals

- Caustic cleaners
- Acid cleaners
- Peracetic acid and other sanitisers
- CIP chemicals
- Keg and packaging cleaning chemicals

When Handling Brewery Chemicals:

- Wear the required chemical PPE before opening or transferring product.
- Make sure hoses, fittings and chemical dosing equipment are secure before starting.
- Confirm the correct chemical is connected before beginning a CIP cycle.
- Be aware that hot chemical solutions can cause **both chemical and thermal burns**.
- Never open tanks, fittings or hoses that may still be under pressure.
- Clearly communicate when chemical cleaning or CIP is underway.
- Rinse equipment according to the relevant cleaning procedure before returning it to production.



HOSPITALITY CHEMICAL SAFETY:

Hospitality chemicals may be less concentrated, but they can still cause serious injuries.

Common Hospitality Chemicals

- Beer line cleaner
- Dishwasher and glasswasher chemicals
- Degreaser
- Oven and grill cleaner
- Floor cleaner
- Bleach
- Sanitiser
- Cleaning sprays

When Using Them:

- Use the correct chemical for the job.
- Don't assume a chemical is harmless because it is commonly used.
- Wear gloves and eye protection where required.
- Never spray chemicals towards yourself or another person.
- Keep chemicals away from food preparation and service areas.
- Never leave beer line cleaner or other chemicals where they could accidentally be consumed.
- Clearly communicate when beer lines or equipment contain cleaning chemicals.
- Flush beer lines and equipment fully before returning them to service.



STORAGE:

- Store chemicals in their designated chemical storage area.
- Keep chemicals away from food, ingredients and packaging.
- Keep incompatible chemicals separated.
- Store containers upright with lids securely fitted.
- Keep chemicals within bunded areas where provided.
- Don't store chemicals above head height where a spill could splash onto someone.
- Return chemicals to their proper storage area after use.



SPIILLS & EXPOSURE — WHAT TO DO:

If a Chemical Is Spilled:

- Keep other people away from the area.
- Identify the chemical before attempting to clean it up.
- Wear the appropriate PPE.
- Use the chemical spill kit where required.
- Don't wash chemicals down drains unless the procedure specifically allows it.
- Don't attempt to neutralise or clean up a major spill unless you are trained to do so.
- Report the spill to your manager or supervisor.

If Chemical Gets in Your Eyes:

- Immediately use the eyewash station.
- Begin flushing with clean water straight away.
- Continue flushing as directed by the SDS and seek assistance.
- Report the incident immediately.

If Chemical Gets on Your Skin:

- Remove contaminated clothing if safe to do so.
- Immediately rinse the affected area with plenty of water.
- Follow the SDS first-aid instructions and seek medical assistance where required.

If Fumes Are Inhaled:

- Move away from the exposure and into fresh air if safe to do so.
- Alert your supervisor immediately.
- Seek medical assistance if symptoms occur.



ADDITIONAL AWARENESS POINTS:

- **No shortcuts:** Saving two minutes isn't worth a chemical burn.
- **Check before you pour:** Make sure you've got the correct chemical and container.
- **Don't smell-test chemicals:** Never identify an unknown chemical by sniffing it.
- **Wash your hands:** Always wash hands after handling chemicals and before handling food or drink.
- **Report damaged equipment:** Leaking chemical pumps, hoses, dosing systems or containers need to be addressed immediately.
- **Report near misses:** A splash, leak or incorrect chemical connection that didn't cause an injury this time still needs to be reported.
- **Know your emergency equipment:** Be familiar with the location of eyewash stations, emergency showers, spill kits and SDS information.



Remember:

STOP – CHECK – PROTECT – USE

Know what chemical you're using.

Check the instructions.

Wear the required protection.

Use it only for its intended purpose.

Chemical safety is everyone's responsibility.

If you're not sure — don't guess. Ask.

Stay safe. Look out for your mates. We all go home in one piece.